

Speaker 1 [00:00:01] Okay. So, all right. So thank you for participating for this interview. And as mentioned over email, we want to know more about your views on romantic relationships. And we believe that your experience and perspective would bring much to the project. And I asked you, but I'll ask again for the recording. Is this okay being recorded? We will only be using notes and transcription.

Speaker 2 [00:00:26] Yeah, it's fine.

Speaker 1 [00:00:29] All right. So just to get to know you a little bit more, um, how old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:33] I'm [15-20].

Speaker 1 [00:00:35] [15-20]. And how long have you been together with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:00:40] Um..[5-10] months? Probably?

Speaker 1 [00:00:47] Got it. And do you have children?

Speaker 2 [00:00:49] No.

Speaker 1 [00:00:52] And who lives in your household?

Speaker 2 [00:00:56] Um, do you mean like where I'm at right now? Or, like, actual?

Speaker 1 [00:01:02] Where you're at right now.

Speaker 2 [00:01:04] Um, I'm in [housing], so [1-5] person.

Speaker 1 [00:01:06] Okay. And what is your main source of income or what is your current job?

Speaker 2 [00:01:15] I am [occupation].

Speaker 1 [00:01:19] All right. And how would you like me to address your partner? Boyfriend, partner and lover? Or by their name?

Speaker 2 [00:01:29] Um, this probably [intelligible].

Speaker 1 [00:01:32] Okay. All right. So from now on, it's just going to be you talking about pretty much anything, um, regarding, like, the questions. And I'll just be taking notes on the side and asking you, like, a lot of questions. Um, so the first one being, um, can you tell me more about your love story?

Speaker 2 [00:01:55] Um, we met at a party. Or, like, we actually met at work, but we've actually known each other for, like, our whole lives. Like, we met when we were, like, [0-5] years old because our parents are family friends. And we basically, like, parted ways after we, like, reached [school] because that was when all of us got older and we stopped attending the family parties. So me and him rekindled back as friends—as friends, like, during work, when I was only a [year] in [school] and he was a [year] in [college], and we just started talking again as friends through work. And then from there, we attended a party. And then after that, we showed interest in each other.

Speaker 1 [00:02:47] Right. And could you tell me more about, like, how that interest grew?

Speaker 2 [00:02:54] Um, it kind of just grew after the party 'cause I grew an attraction towards him. And after the attraction started going, I just started seeing him more and wanting to interact with him more.

Speaker 1 [00:03:09] And what were you specifically attracted to, if I could ask?

Speaker 2 [00:03:14] Um, I was attracted to probably, like, um, his physique, basically. Just, like, how he looks at first because that's what I first see. And then, when I get to know him a lot more, he is actually a really cool person. And I wanted to get to know him to a point where I wanted to see, like, any, like, bad signs of him—which I didn't see at all. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:03:42] And... and you had, like, mentioned a bit, um, but how did the relationship develop? How did you guys become official? Um, you know, things like that.

Speaker 2 [00:03:58] Um, we actually became official because me and him started getting more intimate with each other before we actually decided to date because we were still getting over, um, our past relationships. So we were kind of just talking together and, like, figuring it out. Like, are we still in love with that person from the past? And after we figured that out, we kind of just, like, okay, "are you sure you want to date?" And we just kind of started dating or, like, dating as in, like, not officially together but, like, going on dates and stuff. But after those dates, we kind of, like, confirmed, like, "do you want to be together?"

Speaker 1 [00:04:35] Mm-hmm. And how did you figure out you were over your past relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:00:42] Li'l shitty.

Speaker 2 [00:04:45] I got over him, like, while we were in the relationship already. I was just kind of, like, in it because I don't want to leave yet, but I was already, like, emotionally, like, detached.

Speaker 1 [00:04:55] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:04:56] So like, I didn't really care about them that much because they didn't care about me throughout the whole relationship. So it was really easy to get over them.

Speaker 1 [00:05:04] Mm hmm. That's good. All right. Um. And yeah, you just mentioned it, but could you tell me more about the difference in the quality of your relationship now compared to, I guess I'll start with, like, your friends' relationships, we'll start there.

Speaker 2 [00:05:26] My first what? Sorry.

Speaker 1 [00:05:28] Um, how do you compare the quality of your current relationship with that of your friends' relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:05:35] My friends' relationships?

Speaker 1 [00:05:37] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:05:39] Um, like, do you mean, like, just any friend?

Speaker 1 [00:05:43] Yeah. Your best friends or just your acquaintances... who surround you.

Speaker 2 [00:05:51] I guess the only difference is that, like, instead of, like, talking for, like, a very long period of time, me and him, we're talking to spend about, like, [1-5] months before getting together. But compared to my, one of my closer friends, they waited to get together with them after, like, probably [1-5] years as friends first in order to actually, like, want to date.

Speaker 1 [00:06:21] And what do you think about that difference? I guess I'm talking about a short amount of time compared to, like, a longer time.

Speaker 2 [00:06:31] Um, I don't, I don't really think that me and my friend are really different when it comes to relationships. We're just, like, different compared to our experiences. But, since I feel like people who had their own paces, I don't really think it really, like, really matters to compare me and my friend's relationships. So I don't really feel bad about myself for, like, moving fast. I just—

Speaker 1 [00:06:55] Yeah, of course.

Speaker 2 [00:06:56] I just kind of, like, think about, like, oh yeah, move slow. But I move fast, so it's just like, oh, that's cool that you guys would slow. And sometimes I would think, like, maybe I should have been slower with it. But then, it was like I already had felt, like, a really deep connection at friends first because we'd been friends for, like, a really long time since we were little. So it's just like, I know you so I can go with you.

Speaker 1 [00:07:22] Okay. Um. And can I ask something? Um. Yeah. So why do you think, um, you wanted to somehow, like, take it slow or what were your thinking processes in that time?

Speaker 2 [00:07:44] Um, probably just, like, I was just thinking, like, maybe I should have taken it slow so I don't make any mistakes in the future. As in, like, if I move too fast, maybe I will look at the relationship. And I should have just, like talked—

Speaker 1 [00:07:56] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:07:57] —with them for a little bit more before I committed.

Speaker 1 [00:08:00] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:08:01] Um, yeah, that's about it. And I just, like, I was just thinking that since their relationship is so good, maybe I should, like, follow their steps, but I'm not them, so it doesn't really work out for everybody.

Speaker 1 [00:08:12] Yeah, everyone's different.

Speaker 2 [00:08:14] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 1 [00:08:16] All right. So, can I ask how many, uh, romantic partners you've had in the past?

Speaker 2 [00:08:23] Um, just about, like, the ones I really consider is probably just [1-5].

Speaker 1 [00:08:32] And how would you compare—which is—this was the question that I wanted to ask before—but how would you compare your current relationship with that of your past relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:08:44] Um, my current relationship is really different because the person I have now is very, like, experienced because they also had a very toxic relationship before, so they know, like, a lot about things and how to read people and stuff like that. And compared to my last relationship, they didn't have any experience. So they were kind of more, like, they didn't really know what to do when it came to, like, if I was feeling sad, emotional, or if I felt like he did something wrong, he would kind of just, like, lash out and say he didn't do anything wrong and give a lot of attitude. But compared to the person that I have now, um, they kind of, like, validate me in how I feel and stuff like that because they know how I feel on my end to, like, kind of just, like, you know, be sad over things because they've also been through it a lot in the past. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:09:39] How do they, um, validate your feelings? Like, there's—there's multiple ways, but how do they do it for you?

Speaker 2 [00:09:47] Um, they would kind of just hear me out instead of interrupting me and telling me, like, “Oh, you're wrong. You're—there's, like, no way that's true,” and stuff like that—kind of, like, manipulating me. But, they—the person that I have now, does not manipulate me. He kind of just, like, sits and listens until I'm done and then shares how he feels and doesn't say like, “I'm sorry you felt like that,”—stuff like that. But then the other person from the past didn't do that. They would just ignore me or, like, just tell me to shut up. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:10:22] So you said manipulation, right? What is, um, how would you define manipulation?

Speaker 2 [00:10:30] For me, it would just kind of be like convincing me to think that I said something when I didn't mean to say it in that way. Or kind of like, um, telling me that, like, how I'm wrong and how I should act and how I should, like, they would control me, kind of like, “you can't go out unless I allow you to go out,” or something, like, you can't really see that. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:10:55] And... so why—what do you think makes a relationship high quality?

Speaker 2 [00:11:07] Probably just trust and loyalty because, like, when it comes to trust, it's like you have to, like, trust them to, like, a certain amount where you wouldn't trip about a lot of things. It's just, like, simply, like, as, like, going out and, like, living, like, a distance away from them, if that makes sense. Like, I'm kind of in a long distance relationship, but, like, it's, like, me and I—we live like an hour away from where I'm from. So, it's hard to trust, because since I'm in [housing], they feel like I'm tended to, like, go cheat on someone in a different form—I don't know. And then, um, yeah, if the trust is, like, really, like, strong, then there wouldn't be such accusations like that.

Speaker 1 [00:11:49] Mm-hmm. And you said cheating, so.. how do you define cheating?

Speaker 2 [00:12:00] Um, I define cheating in many ways because I'm kind of influenced by social media. So, um, cheating—probably just being intimate with somebody else, being in a room alone with somebody of the opposite gender of, or like, of my gender. Um, kind of like texting people behind my back, snatching your phone away if I'm trying to look through it or like, kind of like, um, probably just, like, the basics—kind of like hiding stuff from me. And like, not telling me what I want to hear. It's like keeping it away so that they could, like, prevent me from, like, getting mad about it.

Speaker 1 [00:12:44] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:12:45] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:12:48] Yeah, definitely. And, you know, like, even in social media, there's things like what exactly is intimacy? Like, it could be emotional, it could be mental, it could be even just like looking at each other. How would you define intimacy? I guess, like, if you're—would have like, you know, done something and you're like, that's cheating. Right? What do you— how do you, like, what's your thinking process there?

Speaker 2 [00:13:20] Kind of like, when they're, like, too close together when they're just, like, having a conversation. Kind of like if he, like, leans in to talk to the person. Like, why are you doing that? And also, like, probably, like, offering to help the person while I'm right there when I could easily help them myself.

Speaker 1 [00:13:39] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:13:40] Or, um, kind of like offering rides to the girls when the girls obviously have someone that gives them a ride. Um, and be just like, um, interacting with the girls more than interacting with me if I'm present. Then also possibly, like, um, checking a girl out, obviously. Like, when I'm, like, with you, like, why are you looking at another girl?

Speaker 1 [00:14:07] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:14:09] Because it's kind of just embarrassing on my end because it's just like, like, why is my man checking another girl out in front of me? It's just—

Speaker 1 [00:14:17] Right.

Speaker 2 [00:14:18] Yeah, it would boost the other girls' ego. And it's just like this whole thing.

Speaker 1 [00:14:22] Yeah. All right. Hmm... And yes... so on the other spectrums, what makes a relationship low quality and why do you think so?

Speaker 2 [00:14:59] Um, low quality— probably just, like, no communication as in like— but like, instead of just saying no communication, I meant, like, in depth. Like, not telling me where you're going sometimes when I usually ask you, like, um, what time you're leaving your house and stuff like that.

Speaker 1 [00:15:06] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:15:06] Um, probably, like, not telling me your schedule. Like, if I want to see you and then you tell me last minute that you have to do something. It's kind of like disrespecting my time because I'm staying out with you. Also, like, communicating as in a way, like, instead of like, if I'm telling you how I feel, don't just, like, ignore me. Like, look at me— to me and, like, say something after I'm done talking instead of just sitting there. Um, just like, probably like, um, if I'm asking how they feel about something—if they're mad at me and they don't say anything, it's kind of like, I'll give you time and space to think about what you want to tell me. But if it results to just not talking to each other, then that's honestly a problem. Another, like, bad quality is probably, like, the attitude type of thing. It's kind of like, if you know a person is sensitive, don't use that type of tone when you want to talk to them about something.

Speaker 1 [00:16:08] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:16:08] Or probably like, uh, if they were to ask you to do something and you don't do it, it's kind of like... what— why are you doing that? It's just like— I just think respect is really important. And if they don't, like, respect you as, like, let alone a person, it's like— it's a problem.

Speaker 1 [00:16:25] Exactly. Yeah, I agree. And... when would you say your rela— when would you say your relationship was of the highest quality?

Speaker 2 [00:16:37] Um, the current one or the past one?

Speaker 1 [00:16:39] The current one.

Speaker 2 [00:16:41] Um, of the highest quality... uh what do you mean by highest quality? Do you mean, like, throughout it or just, like, right now?

Speaker 1 [00:16:49] Hmm... it could be a situation or it could be... I mean, it just depends on how you see it, like, some people have talked about their relationship— it's like, okay, we started, uh, like, kind of like, you know, and then they started becoming of higher quality. So that's when they talk about what they're doing now. Um, other times it's more of— okay, so there's situations where we communicate really well, for example, other times, like, we get into arguments or things like that. Um, it just depends.

Speaker 2 [00:17:24] Okay. Um, I would probably say, like, like right now is where we're at a pretty high point because since we're not seeing each other as much, we're kind of, like, going, like, I don't know how to say it, but since we miss each other, it's like, we're, like, going to see each other more. Because before all this, it should be about so many things because, um, his past relationship lasted [1-5] years. So I was like, there's no way you want to be with me right now because, like, um, that relationship was way too long. And, like, the fact that you only got over it, like, barely, like, last year kind of concerned me because that was when me and him were starting to talk more. So I didn't really want to be like a side piece.

Speaker 1 [00:18:07] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:18:08] That was— I was, like, really tripped about that.

Speaker 1 [00:18:10] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:18:13] And um, he was also trippin'— trippin about, like, me too. But I think it was more intense on his side because, um, he used to, like, follow his, like, past relationship, like, he used to follow his ex on social media. And they used to, like, talk, like, on messages. And I was just like, why are you talking to her while you're with me? So it's just like— that was a problem. That was probably one of our lowest points, along with, like, when he found out something, like, from like— from my past. That was also a really low point. But after we got past that and then compared to, like, right now, I think we're at a pretty high point because we're always excited to see each other and we kind of just put that stuff, like, behind us. And yeah... I think we're fine now.

Speaker 1 [00:19:00] How did you guys, I guess, resolve that? Um, because you mentioned that your current relationship, he followed their ex on social media and he found out something about you. How did you guys, like, move on? Because— because that's hard, right?

Speaker 2 [00:19:20] Yeah, it's hella hard. Um, we actually, like, moved on from it because he was like, we're— we're already so far in the relationship and 'I'm already growing so much love for you so I can forgive you, but if you were to tell me in the beginning of the relationship, I wouldn't have gotten with you.' And I was like, 'Damn. that can hurt. But, um, so he's basically kind of just reasoning with me about how, like, far we've gotten already and how much, like, we've been through. So he just wants to stay because he actually is committed enough to stay and put— and was willing to put all that shit behind because it honestly didn't really matter since it was from the past. And that's how things happened.

Speaker 1 [00:19:57] That's good. And... and yeah, so this is just a general question but what are the most important things in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:20:12] Hmm... I would probably just say respect, trust, and loyalty to be simple because, like, when you look into each of those things, it, like, contributes to, like, so many things within the relationship. Like, trust—it's like you want to trust them while they're by themselves and not looking at other girls and stuff like that. Loyalty—kind of just like, sticking his head to one person instead of wanting to mingle with other people, unless you're— unless you consent to having an open relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:20:45] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:20:47] But since I don't really want an open relationship, I kind of want him to just, like, think of me as someone that he wants to stay with and not try to, like, find someone else to fulfill so that I can give him.

Speaker 1 [00:20:59] Mm hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:21:00] And then, like, the respect part is just like, it kind of just goes for everybody. Like, if you don't respect me, then why would I want you in my life? That goes for, like, friends and family and stuff like that.

Speaker 1 [00:21:09] Yeah. And how would you define respect? Like, what exactly is respect for you?

Speaker 2 [00:21:14] Respect for me is probably just like, treating me like a person. Kind of like, don't interrupt me when I talk. Like, if I'm offering to help you do something, help me back. And, like, if I'm, like, holding the door for you, you better hold the door for me too

because, like— and then kind of, like, being fifty-fifty on things, like if I do this and you do this. Um, also like respecting my space, like not trashing my whole area and probably just like, respecting the way you talk to me, kind of? Kind of just like, don't, like, just call me slurs or like, like curse words. Just—

Speaker 1 [00:21:50] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:21:51] —talk like a normal person. Kind of just, like, respect everybody around me, too, because how you talk to your peers is what kind of reflects of you as a person.

Speaker 1 [00:22:06] Yeah. And this is more of a broader question, but what is love?

Speaker 2 [00:22:12] I don't know— kind of like, love is just, uh, that's a hard question

Speaker 1 [00:22:21] It is.

Speaker 2 [00:22:23] I guess I would define love as something—when you really, like, want to commit to something. Like, I just think love is a commitment and also, like, a feeling that just happens—I don't know—where you can really, like, grow. You can really, like, make yourself love something. If it just happens, then it just happens. It's just—I just think love is a commitment.

Speaker 1 [00:22:47] Mm-hmm. And how important is it in the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:22:54] Um, I think it's pretty important in a relationship because depending on the relationship, if you want to stay with someone to actually love them and not just stay with them for, like, business or something like that—kind of like an arranged marriage—like that's not love, to be honest—but you can grow to love them. But, um, love is pretty important to go with someone because, like, if you don't love that person, then you're not really going to see a future with them and therefore you're not really going to end up as, like—you're not going to feel good about yourself if you're with someone that you don't really want to be with. And then, like, you would want to hurt them or like you would end up hurting them by doing something else such as, like, finding other women to find love again or [inaudible]

Speaker 1 [00:23:39] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:23:40] Like that.

Speaker 1 [00:23:47] And how do you know your own loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:23:53] Uh, who?

Speaker 1 [00:23:55] Your partner.

Speaker 2 [00:23:57] Oh, um, I think he does, because—well, what he—he will always tell me, like, like how he would spend a lot of money on me even when he did know he shouldn't be. Kind of like going through—for instance, kind of like driving all the way to [city] from [city] to see me, and taking me out and taking me home and stuff like that. Taking time out of his day to, like, just simply, like, text—text me or call me. Um, kind of like reassuring me when I'm feeling down. Like, when I'm like—like if I'm, like, at the gym and I'm like, 'Oh my God, I feel so fat,' because I see everybody else that's hella fit. He would probably text me like, 'No, you don't look fat. You are just, like, working out at your own pace'—stuff like that. It would just—it would just reassure me to, like, keep my mind positive—

Speaker 1 [00:24:46] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:24:47] –if I'm really down.

Speaker 1 [00:24:51] Yeah. You said that he's from [?]

Speaker 2 [00:24:54] Oh, yeah. Me and him are from [city].

Speaker 1 [00:24:56] Oh, really? Me too. What area?

Speaker 2 [00:25:01] Um, I'm from the [location].

Speaker 1 [00:25:04] Oh, really?

Speaker 2 [00:25:05] [location]. But then, he's from [location].

Speaker 1 [00:25:08] Oh, I see. Yeah, I'm from the [location] so...

Speaker 2 [00:25:12] Oh.

Speaker 1 [00:25:13] Yeah. But anyways. All right. Um, so what are some challenges you have in your relationship right now?

Speaker 2 [00:25:24] Um, challenges is probably, like, how much he trusts me since I'm away from him and I'm living in [housing]. So he often feels insecure about himself–

Speaker 1 [00:25:33] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:25:34] –when it comes to, like, appearance wise because my social media is kind of like, just my face and my, like, look. So he would just be like, 'Oh my God, look at all these guys, like, looking at your posts, liking your pictures and commenting and texting you.' And whenever, like, I'm encountering someone trying to, I guess, like, get at me, if that makes sense, kind of like hitting on me. I would immediately tell him because if I didn't, I feel like I'm in the wrong for not telling him about that stuff.

Speaker 1 [00:26:02] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:26:04] Um, I would tell him and then he would get insecure because I am getting attention from other men and he just believes that I may not be loyal to him because I am in college.

Speaker 1 [00:26:19] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:26:21] Like, away from him. And he goes to [college], like [college], so he just stays at home. So his experience is a lot different from mine. So he just assumes that, like, from, like, social media that I'm going to, like, cheat on him because it's what [app] said or something.

Speaker 1 [00:26:39] And do you guys fight? It could be whatever you define fight as.

Speaker 2 [00:26:47] Um, nothing physical. Nothing, like, they, like—I'm-going-to-beat-the-[redacted]-out-of-you. It's kind of—it's more like arguing on the phone. Kind of like, 'why are you being like this?' or 'what's with the attitude?' Or kind of, like, small bickering? But the last time we really argued about something was probably, like, when I would bring up his ex.

Speaker 1 [00:27:07] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:27:09] Yeah. He would just be like, 'why are you bringing that up?' and stuff like that. And then we'd probably, like, just like, not really yell, but use loud voices, like, we would just kind of like, raise our voices at each other and give us a lot of—give each other a lot of attitude. And that would kind of result in, like, us giving a bit of silent treatment and then resolving it after a few minutes.

Speaker 1 [00:27:35] And how do you guys resolve that?

Speaker 2 [00:27:38] Um, we usually resolve it by thinking about what the—what we said to each other, kind of like apologizing for even bringing it up or kind of reassuring each other like, 'I'm sorry I said that. I shouldn't have brought that up because I know that in the past we've already talked about how it shouldn't really matter.' And, um, he would just be like, 'well, if you're bringing it up a lot, then it must bother you and I have to reassure you.'

Speaker 1 [00:28:01] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:28:01] And stuff like that.

Speaker 1 [00:28:04] That's good. And.. um, what are some other ways that you maintain your relationship besides, um, like, resolving, like, this fight?

Speaker 2 [00:28:16] Um, we kind of just tried our best to, um, keep our spark by going on dates and going out to eat. And also just chilling, too—having like time for us to just, like, chill in a way where we just, like, don't talk. We just, like, sit there and hang out. And then, yeah, we would just, like, usually, like, have our time to ourselves, but we're still together, like in that same space.

Speaker 1 [00:28:49] And would you say that your relationship is good for you?

Speaker 2 [00:28:54] Um, I believe it's pretty good for me because he's not really—I'm not really seeing any, like, bad signals or red flags from him. Since, if I were to see red flags, I would feel like he might be inferior to my life. Kind of like, if you're letting me down and, like, like, getting in the way of, like, my college and stuff like that, then it won't really work out. But he—since we're both students, we kind of just give each other time to work on ourselves, though we're still, like, in a relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:29:35] And what are like—could you give me some examples on specific situations where you thought it was, I guess like, it defined or made you feel like the relationship was good.

Speaker 2 [00:29:52] Um, probably this one time when we went to the mall and we would just laugh a lot and make a lot of jokes and just eat together.

Speaker 1 [00:30:01] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:30:02] That was fun. And probably also another time when, uh... I'll just be at his house and we were laughing at [app]..

Speaker 1 [00:30:16] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:30:17] Or like, if I was like, um... I don't really know. We kind of just do our own thing a lot.

Speaker 1 [00:30:26] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:30:28] Um, probably just like... yeah, just probably when we went on dates with each other is pretty fun. And when we chill together. It's just—it's just what we do. It's pretty nice and calming because, um, since, like, he works a lot and I have a lot of school or so I'm, like, on campus and stuff like that.

Speaker 1 [00:30:48] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:30:49] Our time is mainly focused on school.

Speaker 1 [00:30:52] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:30:52] And, um, he's employed—working with kids and stuff like that at, like, YMCA. So, he has to put his whole attention to that because they're children.

Speaker 1 [00:31:02] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:31:03] So like when—so after he, like, he would work and then we would—and then we would hang out after work, we kind of just, like, hang out because we're, like, kind of drained from, like, stuff we do in a day.

Speaker 1 [00:31:12] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:31:12] And that's usually how, like—it's just fun to hang out together because we just have a space where we can just relax.

Speaker 1 [00:31:24] And what do you say that the relationship changed you?

Speaker 2 [00:31:31] Um, yeah. In a way, it changed me because I'm more, like, logical—

Speaker 1 [00:31:37] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:31:37] —when it comes to, like, jumping to conclusions instead of just, like, being like, 'Oh my God, you're looking at that girl. You probably think she's attractive.' I would just be like, 'He probably just has a staring problem.' Like, I'm just like, I wouldn't, like, jump to conclusions to accuse him of stuff. I'll kind of think about it first and just be like, 'it's not that serious.'

Speaker 1 [00:32:01] And what about your partner? Did they change during their relationship? Um, I think they.

Speaker 2 [00:32:08] Um, I think they kind of changed in a way where instead of, like, being like how he was with his ex, he is more different towards me because he's more relaxed now since when he was in a toxic relationship, he's more tense and angry and, like,

aggressive when it comes to that person. But with me, since I'm not that girl, I'm kind of just, like, different—I'm a lot different from her. So I feel like his whole, like, persona kind of changed where he's just more calm, timid, and just, like, he just goes with the flow, I guess. I don't know. He's really nonchalant.

Speaker 1 [00:32:57] And is the person you were before the relationship the same as the person you are now? Uh, no.

Speaker 2 [00:33:07] Uh, no. I would say it's pretty different because before I was kind of just someone that would, like, let them, like verbally, like, be mean to me.

Speaker 1 [00:33:18] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:33:19] But now, I would not, uh, let that shit slide.

Speaker 1 [00:33:21] Period.

Speaker 1 [00:33:30] And how about your partner? Are they the same as before the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:33:39] Um, probably not, because before, they kind of, like, were a lot more clueless and new to relationships. But now he's more experienced. He knows, like, how to deal with me because sometimes I can be too much. And I just think we're different people now because of what we experienced in the past, what we learned from—it kind of just, like, changes us to be more, like, mature, I guess.

Speaker 1 [00:34:13] And would you say you feel safe in the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:34:17] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:34:20] All right. And for this one, I will be sharing my screen just to, kind of like, give you a visualization of, um, my next questions.

Speaker 1 [00:34:44] All right. So... yeah. So 'my partner usually really listens to me'—I'm going to be taking notes on the side. So this is just like a—like a Likert scale, so feel free to say a number.

Speaker 2 [00:35:01] Um, I would say number [5-10].

Speaker 1 [00:35:06] And why do you say that?

Speaker 2 [00:35:08] I would say number [5-10], because he kind of had this habit where he kind of, like, waits. Like if I ask him something, he kind of waits to respond to me after he's done, like, paying attention to something. Like if he's, like, watching YouTube, and I, like, ask him something, he wouldn't respond 'til, like, a minute later, when he actually, like, processed just what I said because his full attention was on, like, the video. So I would just say like number [5-10], since, like, if I want him to do something, he can't do it immediately unless I ask him, like, a minute earlier.

Speaker 1 [00:35:44] You know, why not a [0-5] or why not a [5-10]?

Speaker 2 [00:35:53] Um... [0-5] is kind of just, like, lower because he does listen to me. And [5-10] is too high for him because, like, he doesn't listen sometimes.

Speaker 1 [00:36:03] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:36:05] So I'll just say [5-10], since, like, kind of, like, not a bad thing or everything.

Speaker 1 [00:36:12] Mm-hmm. Like the balance. Okay. And the next one, 'my partner usually is responsive to my needs.'

Speaker 2 [00:36:21] Um, I would say [5-10]. Um, because... uh... because when I, like, ask him, like—well, he kind of just knows what to do already. Just kind of like, if I need something, then he'll, like, reassure me. Kind of. I don't know how to explain it.

Speaker 1 [00:36:47] Okay. And why not at [5-10]?

Speaker 2 [00:36:51] Um, [5-10] is a pretty much, like, lower for him because he is a pretty good, like, responder when it comes to, like—when I actually, like, really need something. I just feel like [5-10] is really, like, a perfect number for how he is when it comes to him responding, because sometimes he could lag or if he's something like that. Kind of like, if I want attention, he'll be there.

Speaker 1 [00:37:19] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:37:20] But I wouldn't say the [5-10] because, like, um... yeah. It's not a question. Um, I wanted to say it's a six because I feel like it's leaning towards the lower side when right there and... damn, I can't really explain this. I don't know how to say it.

Speaker 1 [00:37:42] That's okay. That's okay. Um, why isn't it an [5-10]?

Speaker 2 [00:37:49] Um, I just wouldn't say it's an [5-10] because he is not always going to be really responsive to me. Like I said, like, kind of like, if I want something, I have to, like, ask him earlier so that he's not, like, really immersed in, like, some type of games or something.

Speaker 1 [00:38:04] Mm-hm m.

Speaker 2 [00:38:05] But, usually, like, if I ask him, 'I need something,' he would finish it and then come to me right after.

Speaker 1 [00:38:12] Mm-hmm. Okay. That's fair. All right. So 'how satisfied are you with your relationship?'

Speaker 2 [00:38:20] Um, I would pretty much say, very satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:38:28] And why is that?

Speaker 2 [00:38:30] Um, kind of just like, because he's not really, like, set on his goals. He kind of like—whenever he, like, says or do something, he kind of just, like, doesn't want to do it because he doesn't have the motivation to do it. Kind of like saying, like, 'I'll wake up early for my class tomorrow,' and then sleeps past the alarm and then continues to do that.

Speaker 1 [00:38:57] How does that make you feel?

Speaker 2 [00:38:58] It gets so annoying. Because, just like, if you can't even, like, help yourself, then how are you going to help me?

Speaker 1 [00:39:06] Right.

Speaker 1 [00:39:23] And... yeah. Okay. And then, now going to the next question.

Speaker 1 [00:39:53] Okay. So, would you just, like, go back to the ones you mentioned, um, or the ones... 'My partner is usually responsive to my needs.' You said [5-10]. Um, could you give me an example for that?

Speaker 2 [00:40:21] Just like.. if he's on his phone and I'm also on my phone and I want him to be more close to me, he would do it. But I can feel like he doesn't really want to do it because I had to tell him to do it.

Speaker 1 [00:40:36] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:40:37] And I'll just say that's a [5-10] because I kind of like, um, I would just say it's a [5-10] because, like, he's responsive when I want to be physical with him.

Speaker 1 [00:40:48] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:40:49] But it's kind of just, like—it doesn't feel, like, the same way for him because I had to tell him that he wants—if he wants to do it, like, stuff like that.

Speaker 1 [00:41:04] All right. So for these two questions, um, feel free to say if it's too sensitive for you or you don't want to answer it, but it's talking about your sex life. Um, would you like to continue?

Speaker 2 [00:41:18] Oh, yeah, sure.

Speaker 1 [00:41:21] And so these days, how often do you have sex?

Speaker 2 [00:41:25] Um, once or twice a week.

Speaker 1 [00:41:31] All right. And would you say you're satisfied with your sex life?

Speaker 2 [00:41:35] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:41:37] Okay. All right. So now moving on.

Speaker 1 [00:41:56] And, um, did the relationship, overall—or has it been fulfilling your expectations?

Speaker 2 [00:42:02] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:42:04] And why?

Speaker 2 [00:42:06] It fulfills it because I don't really expect much. I kind of, like, expect the bare minimum, of course. And I feel like he kind of exceeds that because, um—kind of just like the bare minimum—it's just loyalty, respect, and trust for me and he exceeds it by

kind of, like, doing things that I wouldn't expect any person to do—kind of like, if I get with him, he would not look at any girls on social media. He would also, like, not engage with his friends who talk about girls. He would kind of just be like, 'I cannot associate with you all.' Or like, if someone's trying to show a picture of a girl, he would immediately move away because he doesn't feel like it's respectful towards me. And it's just, like, he does things that I wouldn't expect. But it's like something—a really good addition to the relationship. It's really nice.

Speaker 1 [00:42:59] Good. I'm happy for you. All right. So we're close to wrapping up. And give me one second, I need to charge my phone. Okay. [Could you plug it in?]

Speaker 1 [00:43:28] All right. So I'm going to basically summarize this whole thing. Um, so you're [15-20] years old and you've been together [months] with your partner, [0-5] children. You live in [housing] and you said you're living, um, long—or you're long distance with your, um, boyfriend.

Speaker 2 [00:43:47] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 1 [00:43:49] And you're [occupation]. Um, and in terms of your love story, you met at a party but you've known each other since childhood and then parted ways. Uh, met again together in your work, right?

Speaker 2 [00:44:04] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:44:04] Your job?

Speaker 2 [00:44:05] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:44:06] And then, you started getting attracted to him by his physique and his good personality, so no bad signs or, like, red flags. Um, and you—you were more into—you were intimate before becoming official, um, but you did kind of like start dating or going to dates before becoming official. Um... and then you talk more about, like, how you decided to—in terms of, like, becoming official—how you figured out that you guys were over with, um, your exes. So, um, you said you were—you became emotionally detached before, kind of like, the relationship ended. Um, and then in terms of the quality of your relationship, compared to that of your friends, you said that your friends, um, are usually like, they're friends first with their current partners, um, with longer time. But you said that in your case, it's similar in that way even though you guys parted. Um, but the difference is that you guys talked [months], so in that sense it's shorter. And you're worried about moving too fast because you were scared that you would make mistakes, but you realize that there's, like, differences and experiences with everyone. And you believe you made a good connection because of your childhood. And then, you said you only had one other—one other, um, romantic partner. And you said that the difference between the current one and the past relationship you had was that this person is very experienced, um, compared to the other one. And then, um, he validates your feelings, he hears you out, he doesn't manipulate you compared to the other one where they weren't that experience with emotions and, like, actions as well. And you defined manipulation as trying to convince you that you did something wrong or how to act or controlling. And then for what makes a relationship high quality or low quality, you said that a high quality would be trusting each other, and loyalty—so not cheating. We then define cheating and then intimacy as well. Um, and for low quality, you said no communication. Um, you expect, like, in-depth communication, location,

schedules. Um, so that lack of, uh, responding to, like, locations and schedules is a—is of low quality. And for what is most important for you in terms of relationship is that respect. So treating each other with respect, letting each other talk, reciprocating actions like the fifty-fifty thing you mentioned, respecting each other's space and way of talking and no cuss words. Um, trust. So trust—trust each other when they're by themselves. Loyalty—staying with each other, um, unless it's in, uh, open relationship. And for you, love is commitment and something that just happens. And it is very important for you. Love is important for you because it makes you feel good about each other and it prevents bad things from happening. And you know that your partner loves you because, um, because he tends to do things that are—exceed your expectations and he gives you reassurance. Some challenges is due to the long distance, trust, and also you mentioned his insecurity about appearance because your Instagram is full of your pictures and you mentioned, like, people that flirt with you, so there's, um, there's kind of like that insecurity there. And there are arguments, but nothing physical—so small bickering, um, such that bringing up exes. Um, you guys tend to speak in a loud tone or you give attitudes and silent treatment, but when resolving you apologize and you give reassurance to each other. And then, other ways that you maintain the relationship is by going out on dates, eating, chilling, not talking, um, but simply just spending time with each other in the same space. And you said that the relationship is good for you since there were no red flags. Um, if there were, it would make you feel like they were inferior to your life so they would be getting in the way of, for example, college and stuff, and it wouldn't work out. And it's also good for you because, um, you give each other time to work on yourselves. There's laughing, eating, dates—you gave the example of, like, watching [apps] together. And you said that the relationship changed you a bit and making you more logical, um, rather than jumping to conclusions, which is... and for your partner, they changed a bit, um, since—but—oh, yeah, you mentioned that it's more of like the experience of their exes compared to you, how you guys are different and how he's more relaxed. And now your partner is more experienced rather than clueless when he started the other relationship. So overall, both of you guys are more experienced and more mature. And you said you feel safe in the relationship. You said... um... for the Likert scale of 'My partner usually really listens to me', you said a [5-10] because, um, he tends to wait for—hewait—he tends to wait to respond, um, from the other stuff, like, if he's distracted doing other stuff. And—and for 'My partner is usually responsive to my needs,' you said a [5-10] because he knows what you need, he reassures you. It's just that, um, you kind of have to ask him for it rather than, like taking the initiative, I guess. And, um, you guys do it [times] and you're pretty satisfied. And... and you said overall, you're pretty satisfied with your relationship as he fulfills the bare minimum, but also exceeds it by doing things that you don't really expect. And yeah, that's pretty much it. Is there anything you'd like to add?

Speaker 2 [00:52:26] No, it's good.

Speaker 1 [00:52:29] All right. So, yeah. So we're pretty much done. Thank you so much. And now, before we end, um, I want to talk to you more about how we handle the data. As a research project, we want to be as ethically transparent as possible. And so I wanted you to know that the data sharing option—um, wait, I'm going to be considering the data option that you put in the consent form. I have it up here. Uh, you said the full transcription, except sensitive detail can be shared. Um, does that still apply—

Speaker 2 [00:53:03] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:53:03] —or would you like to change that? Okay. All right. And again, yeah, thank you so much for participating in this study. And I would like to let you know that this is also being done in the Philippines, Brazil, Netherlands, France and all over the US. And for

this study to be successful, there's also one more thing that I would like to ask you if that's okay for you.

Speaker 2 [00:53:26] Mm-hmm.

Speaker 1 [00:53:28] Um, could you recommend, like, two close people in your life as nominators? We would ask them for additional couples and those couples you won't really know or interact with. It's kind of like that snowballing effect. And this would give us a diverse—a network as [inaudible] as possible that we can get. Is that okay with you?

Speaker 2 [00:53:50] So I mention like two people?

Speaker 1 [00:53:52] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:53:53] That you could reach out to?

Speaker 1 [00:53:54] Yeah. Um, like from the criteria that I sent over in that email.

Speaker 2 [00:54:02] Oh, um, yeah. I don't really have anyone to—

Speaker 1 [00:54:04] Okay, that's fine. That's fine. All right. So, yeah, so that's pretty much it. Um, in terms of getting into contact with your partner, do you have his email?

Speaker 2 [00:54:17] Um. Yeah. Actually, I don't know—I just have their, um, number.

Speaker 1 [00:54:28] Okay. Yeah, that—that would be fine. Um, so I'll text him to see when he's available, um, and also ask him to sign the consent form. Um, yeah. So what is this number?

Speaker 2 [00:54:44] Oh, he needs to be in the thing, too.

Speaker 1 [00:54:47] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:54:48] Okay. I did not know that. I feel sorry with it.

Speaker 1 [00:54:54] Yeah. Just to get, like, both perspectives, you know?

Speaker 2 [00:55:00] Yeah, sure. So it's required to have the partner in it, too?

Speaker 1 [00:55:06] Yeah. I mentioned it in the email, but yeah—

Speaker 2 [00:55:12] I don't really [inaudible]

Speaker 1 [00:55:17] His—wait—his email, or I mean his number?

Speaker 2 [00:55:20] Yeah. His number is in the chat.

Speaker 1 [00:55:24] Oh, got it. Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:55:40] All right. So yeah. So just let him know. Give him a heads up that I'll be texting him so he doesn't block me. And yeah, so thank you so much again. And that's pretty much it.

Speaker 2 [00:55:54] And, um, for his meeting, is that going to be, like, on his own time?

Speaker 1 [00:55:59] Yeah, it is. Yeah. It's completely, like, separate.

Speaker 2 [00:56:04] Oh, okay. Yeah, he's probably super confused about that. Oh well. I'll make him do it.

Speaker 1 [00:56:13] Thank you. All right. Do you have any other questions?

Speaker 2 [00:56:18] Um, what would happen if he does not consent to it, though?

Speaker 1 [00:56:22] Um, so we would—I would have to just put it down, um, as, like, he didn't want to participate. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:56:35] Does that affect my credit thingy for [company]?

Speaker 1 [00:56:38] Um, I'm not sure. Probably? But I'm not exactly sure.

Speaker 2 [00:56:44] Okay, I'm probably just going to make him do it so I can hear his side of the story too. Sometimes.

Speaker 1 [00:56:48] Okay. Right. All right. So thank you so much and have a good day.

Speaker 2 [00:56:54] Yeah. And also, um, when you also do a meeting with him, by what time do you need the data?

Speaker 1 [00:57:02] Um, hopefully by the end of this week or next week. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:57:08] Thank you.

Speaker 1 [00:57:09] All right. Bye

Speaker 1 [00:57:11] Bye.